Along with picking up a new life, East Bengali migrants in West Bengal also picked up a new moniker. They were the Bangalis as opposed to the local population, known as Ghotis, with legendary stereotyping on both sides. Bangalis were depicted as being coarse, loud and lacking in refined taste and dialect. Ghotis, on the other hand, were depicted as being arrogant and selfish. One second-generation Bangali, whose family moved from Faridpur in East Bengal to West Bengal by train in 1948, recounted:[41]

> Ghotis still claim West Bengal to be theirs only; they still treat us like foreigners, like refugees. They are selfish, self-centred. Bangalis, by contrast, are *dil-doriya* [loving], easy-going, with the ability to bring people closer . . . If you come to my house at 2 p.m., you will have to have lunch with us because it is lunchtime. If you got to a Ghoti house, you won't get any food.

The Bengali penchant for food was matched only with that of football, where the Bangali–Ghoti divide would be on full display, in the iconic battles between East Bengal and Mohan Bagan football clubs of Calcutta.

The Consequences of Partition

The Census of 1951 revealed that 7.5 million people, or 2 per cent of the Indian population, were uprooted from regions in Pakistan due to Partition; around 5 million from the west and 2.5 million from the east.[42] In Delhi, every third person had been uprooted from across the border, in Punjab and West Pakistan every fifth person, in West Bengal, every twelfth person and in East Bengal or East Pakistan, every fiftieth person.[43] Partition also led to internal displacement as migrants moved in to newly vacated territories, and undertook international emigration to Britain and other distant shores. Partition-related displacement had placed a fiscal burden on the newly formed Indian republic to the tune of Rs 1.4 billion up to March 1952, nearly half of which was spent on evacuation, relief and rehabilitation grants, a third spent on housing and a fifth spent on resettlement loans.[44]

The economic consequences of Partition were significant in the long run too, as vibrant trade across lands marked without borders shrunk after the demarcation of strict boundaries. The tea plantations of Assam lost direct